

NOVELISTIC SCREENPLAY

POKÉMON NOCTURNE

EPISODE 05

The Grey Sage's Successive Admonition

Author

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Working compilation

Status · draft · pass 1/3 recorded · EN-GB apparatus

Format	Novelistic screenplay · EN anchors
Target duration	To be set — corpus $\approx$ 95 min read aloud
Units	Incursion (sections) + 10 scenes
Version	2026-09-23 · EN-GB dossier after P1

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Episode sheet

Series Pokémon Nocturne

Episode 05 — The Grey Sage's Successive Admonition

Author Adelbert Vervloet

Logline

The incursion is not a Gym raid. Civilians hold, then give way. Lance smiles and does not act. After Fuji, Oak still does not congratulate: the grey sage admonishes by restraint. Gold/Richter names the Dex as a guard, not as the League. In flight, the Coyote greets.

Place in the arc

Due: creatures of the night (ep. 04); Lance–Rocket; living debt; Red's disappearance.

Paid: crop against Sucker Punch; Chris/Maria's evacuation; Dex "so that no one may misuse it"; Skarmory / Keen Eye.

Open: Murkrow Lv. ~30; the Coyote's voice; Fuji's writings; the truth about Red.

Characters — this episode only

Name	Function here
Gold/Richter	Incursion; inspector; Red's burden
Chris/Maria	Riding crop; evacuation; wound of the Dex
Oak	Fuji's succession; flight
Lance (Team Rocket)	Smile; non-intervention
Karin / Eusine / Morty	Grey-sage discretion; Suicune; Gym
Silver	Gaol / inspector — irony
Coyote / Murkrow	Greeting outside the light

Places (EN anchors)

Ecruteak (streets, Tin Tower, cemetery, take-off ground) · sky between Goldenrod and Ecruteak.

Technical notes — outside the scenes

Heading	Note
Lance	ロケット団かんぶ ランス — Team Rocket executive. ≠ Champion ワタル.

Grey sage	Gandalf (episode title). Karin admonishes by what she does not say.
Incursion	One sequence, BGM sections — not five autonomous scenes. Never Invasion / Raid in titles.
Crops	Gold/Richter: hunting crop only. Chris/Maria: riding crop (short). Never whip.
Abilities / moves	Guts (burned Raticate). Flame Body expected, bypassed by Glare + Acid. Skarmory: Keen Eye, not Sturdy. Murkrow ~30: Night Shade, Haze, Pursuit. Minimize (official spelling).
Metalepsis	No “That is why it stays out of the light” in the authorial voice. Oak’s perception.

BGM index — pieces (OST)

Unit	Piece	Span
Incursion — Always	Always	from 00:30
Incursion — Rebellion	Rebellion	02:25–
Incursion — Don’t Listen...	Don’t Listen to Her	01:40 · 02:04 · 02:30 · 03:08 + Oak / Karin / Silver
Juvenile inspector	Too Heavy	entry
Juvenile inspector	Divine Bloodlines Reprise	S2 title to verify
Coyote’s greeting	She Who Mauls	02:41–02:48

BGM index — traces

Address only. No christening.

Scene	BGM
Well enough equipped...	EP01 S02 19:53–20:33
The Coyote’s greeting	EP01 S02 08:11–09:00

Order

1. Incursion — Always
2. Incursion — Rebellion (02:25) → Don’t Listen to Her

3. Incursion — Don't Listen to Her (Lance · Morty/Eusine · Chris/Maria · grunts · Oak · Karin · Silver)

4. The Old Man Coyote's Derision

5. Death Is Not a Redemption

6. After the Atrocity

7. Some Who Die Deserve Life

8. I Want To, but I Cannot

9. The Suicune-Seeker's Thoughtfulness

10. Thank You for Saving That Idiot

11. The Grey Sage's Successive Admonition

12. A Juvenile Inspector

13. Well Enough Equipped for a Surprise

14. The Old Man Coyote's Caustic Greeting

The scenes are inserted here. The close follows the body.

Scene – The Night Creatures’ Incursion , ‘Always’ section

Ecruteak Street

BGM ‘Always’ (from 00:30)

The night had grown darker around Ecruteak. The low-hanging lanterns cast a warm but faint light, which struggled to dispel the shadows between the buildings. The air was cool, laden with a slight autumnal dampness. The air smelled of cold ash and fallen leaves. An unusual silence had settled over this part of the festival, as if the space itself were holding its breath.

Then the sounds began.

A membranous, deep and unpleasant rubbing sound. A sharp, repeated clicking, like a tongue lashing the air. A dull, almost metallic screech. These noises were not distant. They came from the dark areas, right on the edge of the light.

The civilian Trainers instinctively huddled together, their Pokémon already out. They weren’t seasoned fighters. They knew roughly what they were doing, but not in this sort of situation. Yet they didn’t back away straight away.

A Growlithe and a Vulpix were the first to advance, facing a few smaller forms emerging from the shadows: skittish Ekans, Zubats fluttering low. The Growlithe’s flames and the Vulpix’s little fireballs briefly lit up the area. For a few seconds, the civilian Pokémon seemed to hold their ground. They attacked with a simple, almost naïve bravery. The Growlithe barked once, then charged towards a small, dark shape moving near a low wall. It wrapped its body in a Flame Wheel and slammed head-on into a crawling Ekans. The Ekans was hurled backwards, hissing in pain.

Then the Growlithe, which had just launched a *Flame Wheel*, came to a halt mid-stride. A murky, flickering light reached it from above. Golbat was hovering higher up, almost motionless, its wings barely spread. It was watching. It was waiting. When the Growlithe suddenly turned its head towards its own allies, the civilian Trainer commanding it frowned, then turned pale.

Golbat let out a *Screech*. The cry was long, shrill, and seemed to seep into the bones. The Growlithe charged one of the civilian Pokémon for no apparent reason. The trainer shouted its name, but his voice was lost in the din.

Raticate then burst out of a patch of shadow. Its massive body moved with swift, heavy strides. It sank its fangs into the bewildered Growlithe. The sound was sharp, brutal, almost metallic — a violent crack followed by a dull grind. — a heavy, clumsy Crunch. The Growlithe collapsed without a cry. The Growlithe’s trainer took a step back, his eyes wide.

Golbat descended once more. Its *Wing Attack* struck Hitmonlee head-on. The blow was not especially powerful, yet the Pokémon staggered as if something within had snapped. The impact, magnified by the earlier Screech, sent Hitmonlee reeling several paces. It fell to its knees, winded. Hitmonlee’s trainer swore under his breath; he could not understand why his Pokémon were losing their footing so quickly.

Vulpix then tried something. A *Will-O-Wisp* shot towards Raticate, in the hope of curbing its ferocity. The ghostly blue flame struck the rodent. Raticate growled, its eyes bloodshot. Instead of faltering, it seemed to burn with a new inner fire. It charged at Vulpix with renewed ferocity. The *Hyper Fang* that

followed was louder than the previous ones — the sound of jaws snapping violently, mixed with a sharp, repeated crackling. Vulpix's trainer shouted and took a step forward, then stopped, helpless.

A little further on, Magmar faced Arbok and landed a Feint Attack on it, though it was a weak blow, as the snake had already activated its *Intimidate*. Magmar's trainer waited. He was counting on contact. If Arbok struck directly, *Flame Body* would activate. The burn would weaken the snake's attack. It was a simple plan, but a viable one.

Arbok did not take the bait.

It sidestepped, keeping its distance, head lowered, its tongue flicking out intermittently. It avoided close contact, though it was impossible to tell whether it truly understood the danger, not out of calculation, but out of an instinctive, almost animal-like caution. It circled the Magmar without ever fully engaging. Magmar's trainer frowned, then clenched his teeth. His plan was not working.

Arbok raised its head slightly. Its gaze fixed on Magmar. A moment later, the fire-type Pokémon's body stiffened. Paralysis set in rapidly. Magmar tried to move, but its movements had become slow and jerky.

Arbok then approached unhurriedly. It opened its jaws and fired a stream of *Acid*. The greenish, steaming liquid struck Magmar head-on. The hissing sound of corrosion cut sharply through the cool air.

Magmar's Trainer stood frozen for a moment, his eyes fixed on his Pokémon, which was now struggling to get back on its feet. Around him, the other civilian Trainers were gradually backing away. Some were calling out to their Pokémon in vain. Others simply stood motionless, as if they could no longer issue coherent commands.

The lanterns continued to burn, yet the light seemed to have lost some of its warmth.

End of scene

Scene – The Night Creatures' incursion 'Rebellion' section (02:25) + transition to 'Don't Listen to Her'

Outskirts of Tin Tower. Ecruteak

BGM: 'Rebellion' – from 02:25

The autumn night hung heavy over the outskirts of Tin Tower. The festival lanterns flickered faintly, their lights distorted by the wind, which carried the smells of smoke and turned earth. Gold/Richter had been battling for some time now. His breathing was shorter than at the start, and a thin film of sweat glistened at his hairline. Fearow flew above him, its wings still steady, though slightly less sharp in their changes of direction.

A Golbat burst out of the shadow of a dead tree and fired a Confuse Ray. Fearow veered sharply on its wing, the beam passing mere centimetres from its feathers. Without waiting for a command, it counter-attacked. Its eyes locked onto the Arbok slithering below. A moment later a second Confuse Ray shot from its beak — Mirror Move — and struck the Arbok head-on. The snake writhed, disoriented, but did not collapse. It continued to advance, its head lolling, its tongue lashing the air erratically.

A few paces away, two Koffing were drifting towards a group of civilian Trainers who were already in trouble. Alakazam raised a hand. An invisible wave struck both Pokémon simultaneously. They were thrown backwards, but the effect was slightly less pronounced than if he'd targeted just one. One of the Koffing staggered for longer before collapsing, whilst the other partially regained its feet, still conscious. Alakazam remained motionless for a fraction of a second too long, as if it needed to refocus its attention after having spread its power across two opponents at once.

It was then that five figures emerged from the side alleys.

The Kimono Girls approached in tight formation, their Pokémon at their sides, moving with fluid coordination. Their arrival brought visible relief, but Gold/Richter realised immediately that they had arrived just in time. He did not stop moving.

"Ladies... Do not look into the snake's eyes," he called out without turning round, his voice strained with effort.

The five women scattered immediately, asking no questions. Vaporeon, Espeon, Umbreon, Flareon and Jolteon sprang into action. Their movements were crisp and precise. Several Zubat and Rattata were quickly neutralised. Umbreon fired a Dark Pulse that swept away a small swarm of pre-evolutions Pokémon. Jolteon paralysed two Ekans with a Thunder Wave. The intervention significantly cleared the area, but it did not clear it completely. Threats remained.

A Raticate emerged from the bushes. Its fur bore burn marks, and its eyes glowed with a pained fury. Its Guts ability was active. It headed straight for Alakazam.

At the same moment, a Zubat and a Golbat coordinated their assault. The Zubat let out a shrill Supersonic whilst the Golbat emitted a piercing Screech. The two sound waves overlapped. Alakazam realised instantly that it could not dodge both. It vanished in a blue flash and materialised a few metres away from Gold/Richter... right next to the scorched Raticate.

But no sooner had he reappeared than Alakazam staggered slightly. Its vision blurred for a second. The emergency Teleport had cost him a brief moment of disorientation; it could not immediately follow up with another offensive move. The burning Raticate, already on the move, took advantage of this.

Gold/Richter anticipated the move even before the Raticate leapt. The Pokémon was preparing a **Sucker Punch**. Without hesitation, Gold/Richter swung his hunting crop through the air. The blow intercepted the Raticate mid-leap. The Pokémon was deflected, but not quite enough. It spun round in mid-air and lunged at Gold/Richter himself.

Its fangs and claws passed just a few centimetres from his face. Gold/Richter spun away, but the Raticate's sharp tail grazed him. There was a distinct friction, a contact that was far too close.

Gold/Richter spun round, his body tense, and felt the tail rub against his shoulder. The impact was not strong enough to seriously injure him, but it sent him staggering back two paces. There was a brief moment of imbalance, then he regained his footing and struck again. The hunting crop cracked against the Raticate's flank.

The Raticate fell back to the ground, already severely weakened by the burn and the previous blows. Gold/Richter gave it no time to get back up. He brought his hunting crop down one last time, with precision and force. The Raticate collapsed.

Around them, the remaining creatures were significantly fewer in number. The situation had stabilised, at least in that immediate area.

Gold/Richter and the Kimono Girls exchanged a brief glance. No words were spoken, just a mutual nod. They understood each other.

Gold/Richter recalled Alakazam. Although the Pokémon was still capable of fighting, Fearow offered greater mobility in the current situation: it could fly quickly from one neighbourhood to another, spot the sources of the incursions from the air and respond more effectively to scattered calls for reinforcements. Gold/Richter kept Fearow by his side and headed off towards another part of the city where help was still needed.

End of scene

Scene: The Night Creatures' incursion Section from 'Don't Listen to Her'

Ecruteak Street

Background music: 'Don't Listen to Her' – from 01:40

After walking some distance, Gold/Richter slowed his pace. In a side street, half-hidden in the shadow of a porch, a man was watching the scene without intervening. His attire was unassuming, almost ordinary, but his posture and the way he held his head were all too familiar.

Lance.

Gold/Richter recognised him beyond any doubt. Lance slowly turned his head towards the area where the clash was still at its fiercest and gave an indifferent, almost amused smile. As if to say: *Now is not the time to worry about me.*

Gold/Richter felt a mixture of resentment and regret welling up inside him. He gritted his teeth. He could not stop now. Yet a cold thought forced its way in nonetheless:

If Lance is there and not intervening... then the grunts are probably setting other creatures free elsewhere.

He could not confront Lance at this moment.

He looked away and carried on walking, faster than before. Fearow flew overhead, towards the part of the city that still needed reinforcements.

(End of section)

Section from 'Don't Listen to Her' by Morty & Eusine

Ecruteak Street

(BGM: 'Don't Listen to Her' – 02:04)

The Electrode was already spinning when the scene cut to him, *Rollout*. His run was fluid, almost silent, and he crashed head-on into a Raticate before bouncing off a Rattata. The power was not yet

at its peak, but it sufficed to hurl them aside. Eusine stood slightly to one side, his dark coat fluttering in the night wind. His gaze drifted from one point to another without apparent haste.

A few paces away, a civilian was backing away, his back against a wall, whilst an Ekans reared up to strike. Without a word, Eusine's Haunter leapt out of the shadows to the side. His ghostly hand reached out and struck the snake with a clean, almost surgical Sucker Punch. The Ekans was hurled to the ground. The civilian had just enough time to step out of the way.

On the other side, a Zubat was diving towards a group of passers-by. Morty's Haunter appeared amongst them and attacked in the same way: a brief, precise strike, without excess. Morty, for his part, barely moved. Only two of his fingers rose, in a sharp, precise gesture, as if correcting the Haunter's trajectory. The Haunter obeyed immediately.

Eusine turned his head slightly. His coat was still flapping in the wind. With a discreet, almost elegant wave of his hand, he pointed to a spot further away. Electrode understood. Without slowing down, it altered its course. The sphere was now building up significantly more power.

A Porygon, further on, had just activated Agility. Its body grew lighter, its movements gained speed. It lunged towards Electrode, clearly seeking to outflank or ram him. But the difference in speed remained too great. Even having gained two ranks, it was not fast enough.

Eusine raised his hand once more. This time, his gesture was more oblique, almost nonchalant, yet perfectly measured. Electrode changed course again. The collision was brutal: *Rollout*. The Porygon was sent flying backwards with great force and crashed to the ground, motionless. Electrode finally came to a halt, still vibrating from the impact.

Around them, the nearest creatures had been pushed back or neutralised. Not completely, but enough for the civilians to retreat towards the alleyways. Morty and Eusine exchanged a brief glance. Neither of them smiled. They set off again, each heading towards a different side of the square.

(End of Morty & Eusine section – ~02:30)

'Don't Listen to Her' section: Chris/Maria

Ecruteak Street

(BGM: 'Don't Listen to Her' – 02:30)

Their resistance still held, but it was beginning to crack.

A little further across the square, Pidgeotto charged at a Rattata with a sharp Quick Attack, whilst Venonat released a cloud of Stun Spore, carefully avoiding the other Rattatas. Noctowl, higher up, surveyed the area without intervening directly. The travelling Trainers — Krise, Bryan and Mike — were fighting with whatever they had. Their Pokémon were tired, but they carried on. The situation remained manageable, provided they didn't make any reckless moves.

Chris/Maria's Pokégear vibrated against her thigh. No ringtone. Just a sharp, insistent vibration. She quickly took it out, glanced at the screen and answered without hesitation.

"Yes?"

Gold/Richter's voice was tense, low, almost breathless:

"It's a Team Rocket incursion. Stronger Pokémon are on their way. Arbok, Golbat, maybe more. Don't stay there. Organise the evacuation."

Chris/Maria pressed her lips together slightly.

"...All right."

There was a brief silence. Then his voice came back, a little lower:

"...I'm counting on you. Be careful," said Gold/Richter.

She had no time to reply; the connection was cut off.

Chris/Maria stowed the Pokégear and lifted her gaze. Her expression had shifted. She was no longer striving to hold the area in check. She turned towards the trainers and civilians who remained.

"Take cover. Now."

Her voice was firm, without a tremor. She opened her bag with a precise movement and pulled out a short, supple hunting crop. The leather snapped slightly as she unfolded it. It wasn't a fighting gesture. It was a gesture of **command**.

Noctowl descended at once. Chris/Maria raised two fingers of her left hand in a sharp, controlled, almost surgical movement. The bird understood. It positioned itself above the group and began to emit waves of Hypnosis at the nearest creatures. Venonat, for her part, released a second cloud of Stun Spore – wider this time – towards the Rattata and Zubat that were still closing in.

A Rattata suddenly lunged towards Mini Skirt Krise, fangs already bared. Chris/Maria turned her head. With a fluid flick of her wrist, she lashed the crop forward. The leather whistled and struck the ground just in front of the Rattata, with crisp precision. The creature stopped dead in its tracks, taken by surprise. Chris/Maria stared at it for a moment, her gaze serious and unyielding.

She turned back to the others.

Her expression was serious, almost harsh. She wasn't shouting. She wasn't gesticulating. She merely raised the hunting crop slightly, as if to mark an invisible boundary, and repeated in a lower but heavier voice:

'Evacuate. Now.'

Around her, the roving Trainers began to back away, pulling the civilians with them. The square was gradually emptying. Chris/Maria remained there for a moment longer, hunting crop in hand, her eyes fixed on the shadows from which the creatures continued to emerge. She stood motionless. She was waiting for the last of them to be out of danger.

(End of section – 03:08 Chris/Maria)

Section from 'Don't Listen to Her': Gold/Richter spots the grunts and scientists

Ecruteak Street

(BGM: 'Don't Listen to Her' – 03:08)

Two balls were thrown into the night air. The gesture was discreet, almost languid. They opened without any particular fanfare—barely a muffled crack—in the very spot Gold/Richter and Fearow had just left.

Gold/Richter turned his head.

First he heard the sound—a very faint, almost imperceptible noise, like the rustle of crumpled fabric. Then he saw the two shapes materialising in the gloom: a Zubat and a Muk. He realised immediately. These creatures were not there by chance. They had been summoned **from behind him**.

His gaze swept quickly around the area. At the edge of an alleyway, about twenty metres away, two figures were standing. One was a woman, dressed in ordinary street clothes, but whose overly upright posture and overly composed gaze betrayed something more controlled. The other was a man, taller, wearing a long coat and thin-framed glasses. Nothing about their appearance screamed ‘Team Rocket’. And yet, their presence here, at this very moment, felt anything but natural. A Grunt, a Team Rocket scientist.

They observed the scene without haste. Without anger. Without pleasure, either. Simply with the professional indifference of people carrying out a familiar task. As if they were mentally noting the effectiveness of their deployment, and nothing more.

The Muk, closer at hand, began to contract. Its slimy mass started to shrink, drawing in on itself. Minimise. It was trying to reduce its size, to become a harder target to hit.

Fearow waited for no orders.

The bird dived without a cry. Its body sliced through the air in a clean, almost surgical movement. Despite the Muk’s reduced size, the Aerial Ace struck with chilling precision. It looked as though its beak and talons had severed the gooey mass in several places at once, as if carving into a soft yet resilient material. The Muk was violently hurled backwards, its diminished form writhing under the impact. It was not finished off, but the attack had clearly rendered it harmless for the time being.

Gold/Richter needed not look any longer at the two figures. He already knew what they were.

He turned away and resumed his run, with Fearow soaring back up into the sky above him.

(End of section – 03:30 Gold/Richter spots the grunts and scientists)

Section from ‘Don’t Listen to Her’ Oak

Ecruteak Street

(BGM: ‘Don’t Listen to Her’ – 03:30)

The resistance raged on in a frenzy. The roving Trainers were still fighting, but fatigue was beginning to show in their movements.

A few metres away, Oak took a Poké Ball from his coat. He held it in his palm for a moment, his gaze fixed on the square. He was considering stepping in, if only to take some of the pressure off the others. His arm began to make the throwing motion.

It was at that very moment that three figures materialised in the gloom, about twenty metres away from him. Two Magnemite and a Porygon. Their appearance was almost silent, almost natural, as if

these Pokémon had simply emerged from the shadows. As if they'd been placed there rather than summoned.

Oak paused.

His hand remained in the air for a fraction of a second, then he slowly withdrew it. His fingers tightened around the Poké Ball with restrained force. He did not throw it. His expression remained calm, almost impassive, but his gaze had darkened slightly. He was assessing the situation. Magnet Pull. Skarmory would be too easy a target. He didn't need any more time to realise this.

He kept the Poké Ball in his hand.

A little further away, Gold/Richter, visible but too far away to intervene, briefly turned his head in his direction. He saw the gesture. He understood. Yet he did not stop.

Oak remained motionless for a moment longer, the Poké Ball clenched in his hand, his eyes fixed on the three Pokémon that had just appeared. He did not move.

(End of section – 03:43 Oak)

Section from 'Don't Listen to Her' by Karin

Street. Ecruteak

(BGM: 'Don't Listen to Her' – 03:43)

In a secluded corner, away from the square, Karin clutched Gengar's Poké Ball. Her gaze was fixed on the battles, but her fingers were clenched tightly around the sphere. She watched without intervening. She knew the rule she'd set herself: not to take the place of the local forces, and above all not to reveal her Dark-type Pokémon too readily.

Suddenly her attention was drawn to a group of civilians. Two creatures had approached them, and no one was yet in a position to protect them in time.

Karin closed her eyes briefly. When she opened them again, her expression had changed. The hesitation had vanished. She flung the Poké Ball into the air with a sharp movement.

The Poké Ball opened. Gengar emerged and vanished almost immediately into the shadows, without any visible transition. He reappeared a fraction of a second later behind one of the creatures, landing a precise and brutal Sucker Punch. He moved on to the second one without hesitation, protecting the civilians before blending back into the shadows.

Without hesitation, Karin threw a second ball, at a more oblique angle this time. The moment it opened, Murkrow burst out. Almost nothing could be made out—just a swift, black mist streaking across the space. The Pokémon struck the remaining creatures with restrained, precise force, before vanishing almost as quickly as it had appeared.

Karin stood motionless for a moment. Her expression had darkened slightly. She knew the price such decisions sometimes came at, even when they were necessary. She did not move straight away. She watched for a while longer, her hand hanging by her side.

(End of section – 04:02 Karin)

Section from *'Don't Listen to Her'* by Silver

Ecruteak Street

(BGM: 'Don't Listen to Her' – 04:02)

Gold/Richter threw his Poké Ball. Scyther emerged and immediately lunged towards the flying creatures, taking over from Fearow without waiting for an order.

A human scream, high-pitched and agonised, rang out nearby.

Gold/Richter turned his head. A Golbat had clamped itself onto a civilian and was sinking its fangs into his shoulder, draining his strength. His expression hardened instantly: his eyes wide, his jaw clenched, his gaze fixed on the scene with brutal intensity.

He began to run towards them. In his haste, he turned his back slightly on the shadow behind him. His vigilance slipped slightly.

The Arbok sprang forth without a sound.

It burst out of the darkness like a blade, its body taut, its jaws thrown wide open. Its fangs were already bared, its jaws spread in a posture of pure predation, like a starving animal seeking to bite and tear rather than merely attack. It was neither hatred nor calculated cruelty. It was a biological, visceral, almost mechanical hunger. The Arbok was not seeking to injure. It was seeking to **devour**.

Gold/Richter did not have time to turn around completely. He barely felt the rush of air before the snake was upon him. He turned his head at the very last moment. His expression froze. His eyes widened, not out of sheer fear, but from the sudden realisation that he'd let his guard down. For a fraction of a second, his face showed that he understood his fate was sealed.

A Croconaw darted from the side and slammed into the Arbok. Its fangs sank into the snake with an icy crack — Ice Fang. The Arbok was violently hurled to the side, twisted by the bite.

Gold/Richter took a step back, taken aback. He turned his head and saw Silver, a few metres away, who had just thrown the Poké Ball. Silver was looking at him. His expression was complex: his usual pride was still there, but it seemed diluted, almost overshadowed by the urgency of the moment. In his gaze, a discreet and restrained gratitude shone through, without him saying a word.

Gold/Richter wasted no time. He threw Alakazam's Poké Ball.

The Pokémon appeared near Croconaw and immediately began channelling Confusion at the Arbok to immobilise it and relieve Silver.

Gold/Richter wheeled towards the Golbat. He moved in swiftly and struck it several times with his hunting crop, delivering sharp, precise blows. The Golbat screamed and struggled, but Gold/Richter did not relent. He stepped back slightly, took a running start, and delivered a final blow with far greater force than the previous ones. The hunting crop came down with a thud, the leather cracking heavily through the air, as if seeking to shatter something rather than merely strike it.

The rustle of the leather echoed one last time, more muffled, more heavy.

(End of section – 04:32 Silver)

End of scene

Scene – The Old Man Coyote’s Mockery

Street. Ecruteak

The night sky had returned to calm on the surface. Only the marks on the ground — flattened grass, patches of mud, scattered debris — still bore witness to what had just happened. The characters who had remained at the scene were scattered, yet close enough to one another to see each other. A deep, lingering weariness was palpable in each of them: heavy, irregular breathing, slumped shoulders, beads of sweat on their temples and necks, eyes half-closed or lost in space. No one spoke. Even the most resilient seemed drained. Some leaned discreetly on one knee or against a wall, as if simply staying on their feet already required a conscious effort.

BGM ‘EP03 S01 23:00–23:40’

The remaining creatures were retreating in disarray. A few Golbat fluttered clumsily towards the city limits, as if struggling to maintain their altitude. Ekans and Grimer were dragging themselves along the ground, too exhausted to flee properly. In places, creatures were suddenly absorbed into orbs right where they stood. The spheres closed in on themselves, then rose silently into the air and vanished into the shadows, with no sign of who was recalling them. The grunts and scientists were withdrawing in silence, unhurriedly, as if they had already achieved what they wanted.

Vigilance gradually waned. The feeling that the incursion was drawing to a close took hold. The remaining creatures seemed to be in disarray, with no further coordination. The characters did not move. They were too tired, and the creatures’ apparent retreat gave them the illusion that the worst was over.

Dr Fuji stood slightly apart from the group. He mechanically wiped his forehead with the back of his hand. For a very brief moment, he thought he heard something—a low, almost indistinct voice that seemed to carry a hint of derision. It wasn’t clear enough to be real, and yet it made his blood run cold. He blinked, trying to shake off the sensation.

Suddenly, a projectile was hurled from a position slightly set back. It burst open about ten metres from **Dr Fuji**, who was standing a little apart from the main group. A **Weezing** emerged from it. The distance had been calculated: close enough to seriously injure him, but far enough away that the explosion would not immediately hit the others with full force.

The Weezing slowly turned its head. Its wide mouth opened into a vile, almost obscene and ravenous grin, like a beast finally about to feed. It was not calculated malice, but a biological, almost mechanical cruelty.

The realisation struck almost simultaneously. Several pairs of eyes turned towards the Weezing with a slight delay, then to the blurred silhouette of the scientist who had just thrown the ball, half-hidden in the shadows. In the eyes of some, one could see the precise moment when they realised it was a trap. Yet no one really rushed forward. Their bodies were too heavy, the distances too great, and their realisation too sudden. A few hands rose halfway, then fell back down. One or two steps were tentatively taken, then halted. Their helplessness was plain to see: they knew it was already too late

to intervene effectively.

A short excerpt from *'Don't Listen to Her'* (03:27–03:32) marked this moment of realisation.

The Weezing exploded.

The image was swallowed up by the white and yellow blaze of the explosion.

End of scene

Scene – death is not redemption

Room. The municipal hospital.

BGM: 'EP05 S02 04:40 06:02'

The room is bathed in soft, diffused light. White curtains flutter slowly in a gentle draught. There is no sound of machinery, only that neutral, steady silence, as if the room itself has withdrawn.

Professor Oak stood by the window, his hands clasped in front of him. His fingers were clenched with a tension he could no longer quite conceal. He was not looking at Fuji.

Fuji, lying down, watched him for a moment before speaking in a faint but remarkably calm voice.

'...Why this sadism...?' said Oak.

Oak had murmured this without really addressing him. Fuji made no attempt to console him. He turned his head slightly on the pillow and replied after a silence:

"Not really, as far as I know. He was a member of the team... Just a guess."

Oak did not reply. He kept his eyes fixed on the curtain, his fingers still clenched. Silence fell once more, heavier this time.

Fuji continued, in an even calmer voice:

"My death is no redemption, Oak. My debt cannot be settled so easily."

Oak clenched his hands a little tighter. He finally turned his head towards the bed, but only halfway, as if he were finding it difficult to meet Fuji's gaze. He said nothing.

Fuji looked at him with an almost serene calm. He took a single, slow breath, then added:

"I have come to terms with this fate. I haven't merely... escaped 'the old one'."

This time, Oak raised his head fully. His face froze. He didn't blink. His shoulders stiffened slightly, and he looked away again, staring at a blank spot on the wall. The silence that followed was longer. All that could be heard was the faint rustling of the curtain fabric fluttering in the draught.

Fuji continued, in an even softer voice:

"I'd heard his voice... His whisper. His mockery. Before the atrocity."

Oak stood motionless. His breathing had become shallower, more audible. He was no longer trying to hide his distress. His hands, still clasped together, trembled slightly.

Fuji looked at him for another moment, then closed her eyes. When she spoke again, her voice was almost serene:

“Do not be afraid. I do not believe that God has forsaken me. It is simply that... my life serves as a lesson, especially at a time like this. Yours serves as one too, as long as you are alive.”

He paused for a long time. Oak still did not reply. He stood there, his gaze lost, his shoulders slightly slumped.

Fuji added one final sentence, almost as if it were self-evident:

‘...It is a burden for you. But you simply have to live a little longer, to bear it, without letting it bring you down.’

Then he fell silent.

His eyelids remained closed. His chest still rose and fell, weakly, irregularly. He no longer seemed to be in pain. Just weary. As if he had already found a kind of peace, as if he expected nothing more, and was simply trying not to place any further burden on the one who would remain.

Professor Oak did not move. He remained facing the bed, his hands still clasped, his gaze fixed on Fuji without really seeing him. The silence in the room grew even thicker.

The silence in the room grew even heavier.

The white curtains continued to flutter gently in the calm draught.

End of scene

Scene – After the atrocity

Ecruteak. The following morning.

It was a quiet, almost ordinary morning. The autumn wind blew gently between the buildings of Ecruteak.

Chris/Maria was sitting on the ground in a small courtyard, her three Pokémon gathered around her. She was holding a bag of food, but her movements were sluggish. She was pouring the kibble into the bowls without really looking at what she was doing. Pidgeotto was pecking absent-mindedly. Venonat stayed close to her, almost clinging to her. Noctowl, perched a little higher up, watched her without moving. Chris/Maria’s face was pale, with slight dark circles under her eyes. She wasn’t crying. She was simply trying to carry on as usual, but there was something broken about her movements.

In his hotel room, Gold/Richter sat before his laptop. Gold/Richter stared at the screen without truly seeing it.

BGM: ‘Making Monsters’ – up to 00:45

His fingers remained resting on the keyboard, motionless. He was thinking back to the well. To Lance. To the way Team Rocket had behaved that day.

He had already felt, back then, a certain kinship with Lance — a distorted version, but a kinship nonetheless. That memory was already weighing heavily on him.

But this time the thought did not stop there.

He realised that the affinity went beyond Lance. That it touched on something vaster: the very structure of Team Rocket's thinking. His own way of trying to avoid the mistakes of those who had gone before him, his determination not to repeat the same dead ends... shared a logic, a method, with theirs.

Gold/Richter slowly withdrew his hands from the keyboard and laid them flat on the table. His shoulders froze. He drew in a breath through his nose—a little too sharply—and his gaze became completely lost in the screen. He stopped blinking. For a few seconds, he remained perfectly still, as if moving might make this realisation all the more real.

Then he lowered his head ever so slightly. His breathing had become shallower. One of his hands slowly clenched into a loose fist against the tabletop, before relaxing again.

He did not move any more.

A little further away, Silver was walking through the streets with visible tension in his shoulders. He was packing his things into his bag with movements that were too abrupt, almost aggressive. He wasn't looking at anyone.

Outside his Gym, Morty stood motionless. He looked at the city without really seeing it. His face was impassive, almost blank. He didn't move.

Eusine was walking slowly down a side alley. His gaze was fixed elsewhere, more melancholy than usual. He was walking aimlessly, his hands in the pockets of his coat.

Near Tin Tower, Karin sat on a stone step. She was not praying. She was simply there, silent, her gaze fixed on the city below. Her expression was calm, but there was a kind of long-standing weariness in her eyes. She was taking stock of something she had not yet put into words.

The wind stirred the white curtains of an open window ever so slightly.

No one spoke.

End of scene

Scene – Some who die deserve life

Near Tin Tower, two days after the incursion

BGM: 'Could Not Be Caged' until 00:21

The five Kimono Girls advanced slowly, forming a semicircle. Their footsteps barely made a sound on the ground. The austere fabrics of their outfits, simple and not entirely black, fluttered gently in the wind. They took up their positions facing Tin Tower. Their fans remained closed or barely ajar. Their first movements were slow and restrained: arms rising gradually, torsos bowing with measured precision.

Morty did not move. He stood perfectly straight, his hands clasped in front of him, his fingers clenched with silent tension. His gaze was fixed on a spot on the floor, without really seeing it. He barely blinked. Such violence had taken place in his city. It struck him as an insult he could not yet put into words.

The dance entered a more sombre phase. The arm movements became more sweeping, yet as if laden with an invisible weight. The dancers bowed deeper, their upper bodies bent, as though they were carrying something too large for them. The fans opened slowly, then closed with a faint rustle. There were pauses: they remained frozen for a moment in a position, before resuming.

Eusine had tilted his head slightly to one side. His gaze was distant. One of his hands was absent-mindedly fiddling with the hem of his coat, without him realising it. He wasn't watching the dance. He seemed to be listening to something else, something ancient that had crossed a boundary he had believed to be insurmountable.

The movements became more cyclical. The arms traced slow circles; the steps retraced their path with an almost ritualistic regularity. But breaks began to appear: a dancer would come to a standstill for longer than the others, or a movement would stop abruptly, as if broken. The energy remained subdued, but the repetition was becoming oppressive.

Karin had not moved since the dance ended. She stood slightly apart, her gaze fixed on the graves. Her hands were pressed lightly against one another. During this cyclical phase, she remained particularly still, as if she had stopped breathing for a moment. She realised, though she could not put it into words, that for things to move forward, one sometimes had to pay a price that one did not choose, and which was not always fair.

BGM EP01 S02 '04:30–05:40'

The dance slowed considerably. The movements became minute, almost static. The dancers froze almost completely for several seconds, retaining only very slight tilts of the torso or head. The fans remained open, motionless. It was the moment that came closest to a silent prayer.

Professor Oak stood near the graves. His gaze swept over the headstones, Western in shape, despite the town's Japanese appearance. He was not weeping. He was simply thinking, with cold clarity:

Many of those who live deserve death. And some who die deserve life. Can you give it to them?

The sentence remained locked inside him. He did not speak it.

Gold/Richter, standing slightly behind the group, remained motionless for a few more seconds. Then, without a sound, he turned on his heel and walked away along the narrow path leading to the neighbouring woods. His steps were measured, almost silent. No one seemed to notice him.

Except for Chris/Maria.

She watched him go. She didn't immediately understand why he was leaving. Nor did she try to understand. She waited a moment longer, until the Kimono Girls had bowed together for the last time, then she began to follow him at a distance, without calling out, without hurrying. It was simply a mixture of curiosity and silent solidarity. She did not yet know what she was going to find.

Behind them, Eusine and Morty exchanged a brief glance. They said nothing. They began to approach the path quietly, without haste.

The wind continued to blow through the rocks.

End of scene

Scene – I want to, but I cannot

The atrocity unfolds before Ho-Oh's small altar

(BGM: 'Little Boy Belmont' – to be played at the appropriate moment, probably around the time Gold/Richter realises what is happening)

Ho-Oh's small altar stood amidst the trees, inconspicuous, almost forgotten. The morning light filtered through the leaves, casting shifting patches of light upon the stone. The wind caused the branches above to rustle softly. In the distance, one could still hear the faint rustling of the Kimono Girls' fabrics as they dispersed. Gold/Richter was kneeling before it, his back straight, his hands resting on his thighs. He did not move. His prayer was silent, yet intense. He had been praying with a quiet, almost obstinate devotion, as if seeking to lay down something too heavy for him to bear alone. His gaze, veiled, seemed to pass through the monument without really seeing it. He had let down his guard completely. The world around him existed now only as background noise.

Chris/Maria came to a halt some twenty paces back. She had followed him in silence, impelled by a curiosity shot through with concern. Seeing him so absorbed, she did not dare to draw near. Something in his posture held her back. She stood there, at the edge of the path, watching him from a distance. She felt that interrupting this moment would be a form of intrusion. She did not yet understand why he had come here, but she sensed that it was important to him.

BGM 'EP06S01 10:08–10:37'

Gold/Richter slowly came round. His gaze first fixed on the stone, then drifted further away, into the void. He didn't move straight away. Images came back to him in fragments, too vivid, too physical:

The sharp, heavy flapping of a Golbat's wings. A man's stifled scream. The viscous, warm sensation of a Leech Life sinking into a shoulder. The sudden movement of a sharp tail in the shadows. The sudden leap of a Raticate, fangs already bared. The slow stretch of a forked tongue in the shadows, just before the Arbok sprang forth.

He drew in a breath deeper than he would have liked. These creatures were not spectacular monsters. They were commonplace. Opportunistic. Filthy. And that was precisely what troubled him the most.

He slowly straightened up. That was when he sensed a presence behind him. He turned halfway round. Chris/Maria was standing there, a few paces away. She had not spoken yet. She was simply watching him, with an expression he could not quite make out at first. Chris/Maria then approached, giving up on maintaining her distance. Her footsteps were light on the carpet of fallen leaves.

Gold/Richter kept his eyes on the altar for a moment before turning his head slightly towards her. When he spoke, his voice was low, almost weary:

'I wish Master Ho-Oh would bring them back... just as He did for the Legendary Beasts. But it seems He does not wish to upset the balance of the world. I can only entrust them to the afterlife.'

Chris/Maria took a step forward. She did not reply straight away. She looked at the small altar, then at Gold/Richter. When she spoke, her voice was soft, but a little hesitant:

“You’re still praying, aren’t you? Just like before?”

Gold/Richter gave a bitter, almost imperceptible smile.

“Yes. When I feel lonely and helpless, I put my trust in Him. Does that bother you?”

She shook her head gently.

“No. You haven’t changed. At least... not in what matters. It’s... a relief to me.”

Silence fell. Chris/Maria lowered her eyes slightly, then looked up at him again. She seemed to be searching for the right words.

“But everyone is haunted by what happened. And yet... it was you who came here. Not the others. This is the first time I’ve seen Pokémon cause such bloodshed in this way.”

Gold/Richter remained silent for a moment. His gaze was fixed on the monument, but he was no longer truly seeing it. He lowered his eyes slightly towards the ground. It took him a moment to reply.

BGM: ‘Little Boy Belmont’

“It is not exactly the cruelty that troubles me the most. It is... why these particular Pokémon. Why such ordinary, run-of-the-mill creatures. If they were spectacular monsters, it would make sense. But they are just urban pests. Things one comes across every day without giving them a second thought.”

He paused for a moment. His voice dropped even further.

“As if we were being told that the most terrifying things don’t come from elsewhere. That they’re already here. That they can emerge from anyone... or anything.”

He paused. His breathing was a little shallower than before.

“I met Lance that evening,” he continued. “I dispelled my earlier doubts. I’d thought he’d blackmailed me to help his team escape... and that he’d anticipated my limitations. But that was only half the truth.”

Chris/Maria listened without interruption.

“I thought his motive was a form of loyalty to his team,” continued Gold/Richter. “But that night, their accomplices disguised themselves to carry out that terrorist attack... and they were prepared to sacrifice those Pokémon. Urban pests. Disposable. If the cost of his grunts exceeds their value, he’ll do the same.”

He clenched his fists slightly against his thighs.

“I thought Lance was my opposite. And already so cruel. I was wrong. He didn’t just anticipate my thoughts. He staged this spectacle to maintain internal cohesion. But all of that was just part of his plan. His true nature is... calculating. Inhuman. Monstrous.”

His voice dropped another notch.

“I thought that if I remained cooler, more level-headed, I could avoid what happened to Red. But the direction modern Team Rocket is taking... it’s too close to what I’m trying to do. Not in terms of the goals. In the way of thinking. Like a mirror. And it’s haunting me.”

Chris/Maria looked at him for a long time. She seemed to be weighing up what he'd just said. When she spoke, her voice was calm but firm:

"Well then, I've got myself a Pokédex. I want to share this burden with you."

Gold/Richter slowly turned his head towards her. There was a look of weariness mixed with tenderness in his eyes.

"I asked you not to get involved..."

Chris/Maria smiled faintly.

"And I told you that you weren't alone in this grim affair."

Gold/Richter lowered his eyes for a moment. When he looked up again, his expression was darker, more vulnerable.

"I'm sorry for putting our childhood feelings aside."

Chris/Maria looked at him, and something in her smile faded slightly.

"Oh... so, in that sense, would you have liked to relive the past?"

Gold/Richter did not reply straight away. His gaze grew darker, almost distant.

"Yes," he said at last. "But I can't."

The words hung between them, simple and final. Chris/Maria felt the impact more keenly than she would have liked. She looked away briefly, just long enough to regain her composure.

Gold/Richter continued, in a lower, almost pleading voice:

"You're quite right to be sarcastic. But you should know that boys are easier to hurt than people sometimes realise."

He was not looking at her as he said this; instead, he stared at the floor, as if struggling to bear the weight of his own admission.

Chris/Maria remained silent for a moment. When she replied, her voice was soft, almost cautious:

"Am I to take that as an implicit accusation?"

Gold/Richter shook his head slowly.

"Not at all. I don't want to put too much distance between us."

A faint rustling of leaves made them turn round. Eusine and Morty were emerging from the path, unhurried. Eusine wore his usual smile, but tinged with an unusual seriousness. Morty, behind him, had a neutral, almost indolent expression.

Eusine stopped at a respectful distance.

"Youth is a rare and precious commodity... especially in times like these," he said in a soft, almost sing-song voice.

Chris/Maria gave a slight start.

"Have you been listening to us for a while?"

Morty replied calmly:

"Not on purpose. But we've heard the gist of it."

Eusine nodded, his smile widening slightly, though without any cheer.

"The spectre of the archaic world has crossed the borders. Team Rocket is no longer just their problem... it has become ours."

Gold/Richter looked at him, his eyebrows slightly furrowed.

"The spectre... which world are you talking about?"

Eusine kept his tone light, almost playful, but his eyes remained serious.

"From Kanto? Team Rocket represents an invasive menace to Johto. They do not even trust Johto's Pokémon. They no longer use only Pokémon from their own region. They are pursuing a more antiquated... and more corrupt order."

BGM "EP04S02 15:00–15:19"

He paused, then added with a wry smile:

"By the way, do you have a few minutes to spare, Gold/Richter?"

Gold/Richter regarded him for a moment, then nodded slowly.

"Yes. Whenever suits you."

End of scene

Scene – The Suicune Hunter's Consideration

Conversation between Eusine and Richter. In the woods, near Ho-Oh's small altar

(Immediately after the conversation with Chris/Maria.)

They moved a little further away from the path, into a denser copse where the sound of mourning could barely be heard. The wind rustled the tall leaves. The smell of turned earth and cold ash lingered, subtle but persistent.

Eusine stopped. He did not turn towards Gold/Richter straight away. He let a moment pass, his eyes raised towards the branches.

'You and Chris/Maria... you introduce yourselves as brother and sister, don't you?'

"EP04 S02 18:10–19:00"

Gold/Richter lowered his head. He did not reply straight away. His hands, which had been hanging by his sides, slowly clenched into two tight fists. It took several seconds before he murmured, in a low voice:

"That's what we're leading people to believe."

Eusine nodded gently. A very faint, almost sad smile touched his lips.

"It goes beyond that, doesn't it?"

Gold/Richter did not look up. He stared at a spot among the fallen leaves at his feet. His shoulders stiffened, and he turned his upper body slightly to one side, as if trying to turn away from something he did not want to face.

Eusine continued, in a low, almost dreamy voice:

"I saw you the other day. When you picked up his pen. You brushed against his hand... and you pulled yours away as if you'd just burnt yourself."

At these words, Gold/Richter froze completely. He turned his face away more decisively this time, almost as if he'd been slapped. His fingers clenched with restrained fury, and he lowered his head a little further, until his chin almost touched his chest. He made no attempt to deny it. He simply seemed to want to vanish.

Eusine did not press him. He let the silence hang for a few seconds, then continued with respectful gentleness:

'If you were truly brother and sister, that gesture would never have happened. But I'm not saying this to accuse you. I know that feeling... the feeling of having to hide something precious, for fear of sullying it.'

Gold/Richter remained silent. He lowered his eyes to his own hands. For a moment, he looked at them as though he no longer recognised them, or as though the memory of that touch still burned his fingers. He slowly clenched his fists, then opened them again, as though trying to shake off a sensation he couldn't seem to dispel. There was a kind of silent, almost resigned defeat in his posture.

Eusine looked at him from the side, without pressing the matter.

'Your relationship... it's fragile. But it's also very precious. Don't let fear shatter it. That's all I wanted to say.'

Gold/Richter said nothing. He kept his eyes fixed on the floor, his shoulders slightly hunched. A very slight twitch crossed his face, as if Eusine's words were causing him pain. He did not lift his head. He seemed to be carrying something too heavy for him, something he refused to put down.

After a long silence, he finally murmured, his voice low and slightly hoarse:

'...You're just an independent cultural researcher... or a Suicune hunter, aren't you?'

Eusine let out a soft, almost sad chuckle.

'Among other things. But tonight, I am simply a man who knows what is worth protecting.'

He bowed slightly, with a touch of theatrical grace, then walked away without another word.

Gold/Richter did not move straight away. He stood there, his gaze fixed on the floor, his hands clenched slightly. He looked down one last time at his right palm—the one that had brushed against Chris/Maria's hand—then slowly closed it, as if refusing to hold on to the memory of that touch.

End of scene

Scene – Thank you for saving that idiot

Near Tin Tower and the cemetery

(Two days after the incursion. Just after the funeral dance.)

The smell of turned earth and cold ash still hung in the air, faint but lingering. The wind swept between the stones with a cold, steady breeze. Most people had dispersed after the dance, leaving behind only a heavy, somewhat hollow silence.

Gold/Richter emerged from the forest path. His pace was measured, but his gaze remained somewhat lost, as if he hadn't quite returned from his prayer yet. Eusine was already there, standing a little apart, his hands in his coat pockets. Morty and Chris/Maria arrived almost at the same time, coming from another direction.

Silver was kneeling near several graves, his back slightly hunched. He pretended to be looking at the headstones, but one could sense that he was mainly trying not to draw attention to himself. He avoided eye contact, as if he preferred to remain on the sidelines.

Chris/Maria spotted him. She hesitated for a moment, then approached with light, slightly hesitant steps. She stopped a few paces away from him, her hands clasped in front of her, clearly uncomfortable.

'...You,' she murmured. 'My sincere gratitude...'

She glanced slightly to one side, towards Gold/Richter, as if to illustrate her words.

"...For saving that idiot."

Silver looked up. He didn't reply straight away. He looked at her for a moment, surprised, then lowered his eyes to the ground. He clearly didn't know what to say. He didn't know her well enough to respond naturally, and Chris/Maria's embarrassment was so palpable that it seemed to make her even more awkward.

Gold/Richter then approached, calmly. He understood the situation immediately. Chris/Maria took the opportunity to slip away discreetly, without saying another word, her gaze averted.

Gold/Richter came to a halt before Silver. He paused for a moment, then said in a low but sincere voice:

'I owe you my life from earlier.'

Silver looked at him. A half-smile appeared on his face, both sarcastic and protective.

"I'll gladly accept that—from you... and from your little companion."

Gold/Richter froze slightly. A flush rose to his cheeks. He realised immediately that Silver hadn't seen everything — just snippets, probably when he'd arrived in the vicinity. But that had been enough. Even a partial and chance observation had been enough for Silver to guess something. The thought embarrassed him more than he would have liked.

He lowered his eyes for a moment, then replied in a slightly lower voice:

'We're not really.'

Silver shrugged slightly, still in that tone that was half-sarcastic, half-protective:

“Just as well. If the prison were no longer there, the convicts would have had nowhere to take shelter.”

Gold/Richter let a moment of silence pass, then replied with a weary half-smile:

“As a prisoner, your performance is actually quite ideal, to tell the truth.”

Silver let out a brief, almost dry chuckle.

“Oh, that’s thanks to the jailer—he’s excellent... If he weren’t here, I couldn’t guarantee my actions would be up to this standard. You know full well that not everyone our age is capable of dealing with adults as well as you do. As for me, I lack experience in that area.”

BGM: “EP03 S02 08:10–08:50”

He fell silent for a moment. His tone changed slightly, becoming more neutral, almost introspective.

“...However, I must admit that I never imagined Team Rocket would go this far. A murder on this scale...”

He looked down at the graves. For a few seconds his expression lost some of its usual sarcasm; he seemed genuinely shaken by what he had seen.

He looked up and asked, in a lower voice:

“I don’t rule out the possibility that I’m the strongest Trainer. But... can that really prevent an atrocity like this?”

Gold/Richter remained silent for a long moment. He looked at Silver, then at the graves, then back at Silver. He thought of Red. Of others. Of everything he’d hoped to avoid by choosing a different path. The question hung heavily in the air.

He finally replied, in a calm, somewhat weary voice:

“I’d like to believe it was that simple, too.”

He did not correct Silver. He did not elaborate. He simply let the sentence hang between them, heavy and unanswered.

Silver said nothing. He looked down at the graves again, his gaze lost in thought.

The wind continued to blow through the rocks.

End of scene

Scene – The Grey Sage’s successive admonition

The sequel. Near Tin Tower and the cemetery

The autumn wind swirled a few scattered petals amongst the graves. They fluttered in the air, hesitated, dropped in jerks before falling. The scent of fresh earth and cold ash lingered in the air,

light yet persistent. Most people had moved on after the dance, leaving a heavy silence, disturbed only by the faint rustling of dead leaves.

BGM 'EP01 S02 25:40 – 27:00'

Professor Oak was still kneeling before Dr Fuji's grave. He hadn't moved for quite some time. His hands lay flat on the stone, his fingers slightly clenched. His gaze was fixed on the engraved name, but he no longer seemed to be really seeing it. There was a kind of ancient weariness in his posture, almost resigned.

Gold/Richter approached unhurriedly. He stopped a few paces away, respecting the silence.

"Our deepest condolences, Professor."

Oak raised his head slightly, as if returning from a great distance. He did not sit up straight.

'There's no need,' he replied in a calm voice. 'We weren't friends. Not in the way people usually mean it.'

Gold/Richter looked down at the grave, feeling a little uncomfortable.

Oak continued, almost as if talking to himself:

"He wanted to be buried here. Not in Kanto. He wanted to be closer to God... or whatever he could still reach. As for me, I don't know if it was pride, devotion, or simply weariness. But his wish was granted."

A silence fell. Oak gripped the edge of the stone a little tighter.

"He wasn't a saint. Nor was he a perfect role model. He was a fallible man, like the rest of us. He tried to make amends where he could, to turn his mistakes into something useful. And despite that... he didn't escape this sort of end. Sometimes I wonder if that's what he deserved. Or if it's simply what happens when you truly commit yourself."

Without realising it, Oak turned inwardly to the Lord. *'Why do so many who live deserve death, and some who die deserve life...?'* It wasn't a reproach. It was simply that he couldn't quite grasp the true answer.

Gold/Richter finally turned his head slightly. Karin was standing a few paces away, standing back a little. He'd noticed her earlier, though he wasn't sure.

'You... I don't recall seeing you during... the disaster. I'm sorry. Perhaps I simply wasn't in a state to notice much.'

Karin did not step forward straight away. She looked down at Dr Fuji's grave, then looked up again.

"It's not a false impression. I did take action. But I had to remain... discreet."

A silence. Gold/Richter searched for the right words. His voice came out lower than he'd intended.

"We're free to act or not to act, even when we have the means to do so. But... to say that with power comes responsibility is still too simplistic, isn't it?"

The sentence hung in the air. Karin didn't reply straight away. Something tensed ever so slightly in her gaze — an old wound, quickly brought under control. Oak, who had sensed the change in the atmosphere, was about to speak when Karin spoke first, in a calm, almost weary voice:

“Collective progress sometimes costs us those who are the wisest and most capable. Even those who are dear to us.”

BGM “EP01S02 12:00–13:54”

The words fell into the silence.

Oak, still kneeling, did not raise his head. His fingers, already resting on the edge of the stone, clenched tighter. His knuckles turned slightly white. He did not move a centimetre, but one could sense his back stiffen slightly, as if an extra weight had been added to the one he was already bearing.

Morty, standing a little way back, slowly lowered his eyes to the ground. His left hand closed very slightly around the hem of his sleeve, a discreet, almost childlike gesture. He remained motionless, his gaze fixed on nothing in particular.

Gold/Richter turned his head slightly, as if he’d taken a blow more direct than he’d expected. He didn’t move his feet, but his shoulders froze for a brief moment. He looked down at the grave, and one could see his jaw clench ever so slightly. He made no attempt to hide his unease; he simply seemed to need a moment to contain it.

Karin made no attempt to add anything. She exhaled slowly through her nose, a controlled, almost silent breath. Her fingers loosened their grip on her sleeve. She remained steady, but the silence that followed was heavier than the previous ones.

She paused. Her voice dropped even further:

‘It’s not easy to accept. Not even for me, who understands it. But I can’t watch over you all the time. The local people need to learn to rely on themselves, too.’

Morty broke the silence that followed. He spoke softly, almost to himself:

‘I’ve heard some foreigners say... that death isn’t just a curse. That it could be... a kind of gift. I cannot yet put it into words. But I believe that respecting death means accepting that we are all finite, all fallible. And perhaps that is why we can still learn, even from those who have gone before us. Humbly and mindfully.’

He stopped there, without adding any further lesson.

Karin lowered her eyes for a moment. She seemed a little relieved, but not entirely.

“I didn’t expect you to say that,” she murmured. “But... thank you.”

She kept her eyes on the grave. Her voice returned, softer:

“This price isn’t seen as fair. And I’m not sure I can really come to terms with it. Even knowing why I chose to stay in the background. Otherwise... I wouldn’t know how to justify the fact that someone like Dr Fuji is gone. May the Lord allow it.”

BGM ‘EP02 S02 15:20–16:20’

She fell silent for a moment, then added, almost to herself:

“But I’m also pleased... that so many people have become strong and capable... without me really realising it.”

She looked up at Gold/Richter. Her voice was softer, almost weary:

"You fought well. Not just because you fought yourself, but because you respected your teammates. It's rare to see someone of your generation do that so naturally."

Gold/Richter did not reply straight away. He lowered his eyes slightly, clearly feeling uncomfortable.

'...I don't know if I deserve this praise,' he said at last, in a low voice.

Karin looked at him for a moment, then nodded gently.

"Yes. Yes. It is yours."

A shorter silence fell. Gold/Richter finally spoke, his gaze still downcast, his voice tinged with remorse:

"I'm sorry for my flippant remarks..."

Karin looked at him for a moment. Her reply came unhurriedly, almost gently:

"It is venial. Our paths will probably cross. One day."

Gold/Richter did not look up at once. He had understood what she was implying — her status, her restraint, the reason she had not given it her all during the incursion. Yet he did not wish to know more. Not now. Not until Team Rocket was behind him.

"Better not," he murmured. "And I'll have to deal with Team Rocket... no doubt."

Karin watched his profile for a moment. She did not smile, but there was a very slight softening in her expression.

"Be that as it may. Sometimes trainers reach me in a more... targeted way. Sometimes hesitating a little, even wavering, allows you to see things more clearly afterwards. It isn't always a waste of time. Everyone moves at their own pace."

She was not seeking to encourage or restrain him; she was merely stating a fact. In the silence that followed, Gold/Richter understood that she asked nothing more of him than not to hurry for the wrong reasons.

She turned slightly towards Professor Oak.

"I'm sorry, Professor. I didn't mean to monopolise the conversation. If it's too early to judge whether Dr Fuji's death was in vain."

Oak remained silent for a long moment. He still hadn't looked up. When he finally spoke, his voice was calm, almost resigned, with a hint of self-deprecating sarcasm:

"Red has already made me immune to this sort of situation. My age protects me somewhat from being shaken. But I'm still surprised... to see young people having to reach this sort of clarity so early. It's not necessarily something to be envied."

He said nothing more. He kept his eyes fixed on the grave, his fingers still resting on the stone.

Karin bowed her head slightly, without replying. She took a discreet step back to make room for Oak and Gold/Richter.

The wind continued to swirl the last few petals amongst the graves.

End of scene

Scene – A Juvenile Inspector

The end of the funeral, before Oak's departure *(Two days after the incursion. Near Tin Tower and the cemetery, Ecruteak. Autumn, daylight.)*

Another silence followed. Oak still did not look up.

Then, with a touch of weary, almost casual irony:

'By the way... "bureaucrat" is far too modest a title for you.'

Gold/Richter felt a flush rise to his cheeks. He lowered his chin slightly, his gaze shifting briefly to the ground.

Silver, who had been standing a little way back, chose that moment to speak. His voice was calm, slightly ironic, without any aggression.

'Even as a gaoler, or as a superintendent...?'

Chris/Maria replied almost without pause, as if continuing an internal monologue:

"Is it going to turn Professor Elm's laboratory into an investigation office, or a police station...?"

Gold/Richter gripped the hunting crop he was holding a little tighter.

'I urge restraint...' he murmured. His discomfort was evident, though subdued.

Eusine, who had been watching for a while, turned his head slightly. His gaze fell obliquely on the hunting crop.

"To my knowledge, this weapon is not specifically intended for combat," he said in a tone that was both curious and slightly pedantic. "It is used by the aristocracy for hunting. But also by certain figures, such as detectives. You give the impression of using it to unearth the truth, rather than merely to fight."

Gold/Richter did not reply straight away. His fingers tightened ever so slightly around the leather of the hunting crop. He lowered his gaze.

The silence that followed was a little longer than the previous ones. Finally, a petal fell, more directly, and landed near his shoe.

Oak, still kneeling, spoke without looking up. His voice retained a kind of good-natured mischief, but was softer:

"According to Elm, you're not even trying to challenge the League... your ambition is limited to Gym badges. That's just a bit unconventional for someone who's willing to put up with a Pokédex."

Gold/Richter remained silent for a moment. When he spoke, his voice was low, his gaze still fixed on Dr Fuji's grave.

"...Professor. I took on my Pokédex so that no one could misuse it... so that no one could misuse it to harm others."

BGM 'Too Heavy'

An even heavier silence fell. Chris/Maria looked at him. Her expression grew tense, almost hurt, though she didn't say a word.

"You did it solely for that reason...?" she asked at last, her voice a little lower.

Gold/Richter did not look at her straight away.

"Not the only one... but the main one."

The wind picked up a little more. The petals swirled lower, closer to the ground.

Oak still didn't look up. His fingers, resting on the stone, clenched a little tighter. He said nothing. Gold/Richter finally spoke, his voice low, his gaze fixed on Dr Fuji's grave:

"...I didn't mean to outdo Red. I just... wanted to share some of his burden."

Chris/Maria looked at him. Her expression hardened slightly, as if something were hurting her without her being able to put her finger on it.

Gold/Richter continued, almost as if talking to himself:

"It is too frightening — that even Red was frustrated by something unknown. If even he wasn't enough... then perhaps our ultimate legacy, our tradition... is no longer enough to protect us."

He paused. The wind picked up a little more. Another petal fell, more directly this time.

"I set out to prove that our heritage could still protect us. But my journey... has coincided with that of Team Rocket. And it is no longer the same organisation it was in Red's day. Their cruelty... their deviousness have reached new heights. It has come too soon. Now... I can no longer escape."

The silence that followed was even heavier. Chris/Maria looked down at the ground. Oak, kneeling, gripped the edge of the stone a little tighter. His knuckles turned slightly white.

One of the Kimono Girls finally broke the silence. Her voice was calm, almost weary.

"Johto has changed over the years. A... suffocating atmosphere has begun to surround it. Events have taken a darker turn."

Eusine nodded slightly.

"Red's disappearance has terrified the whole of Johto. Perhaps even more so than in Kanto. People haven't really been able to recover from it."

Gold/Richter raised his head slightly, surprised.

"What do you mean...?"

Karin, standing a little further away, spoke after a silence. Her gaze was fixed on the graves.

"Red... a brave lad who fought back against evil by embodying the virtues we hold dear here. A child who inherited our values without blood ties or a sense of belonging."

Another of the Kimono Girls added, more softly:

"So much so that the locals share your fears. If even this boy didn't survive... wouldn't the tradition crumble? In the face of challenges such as modernisation?"

She paused. Her hands clasped together slightly.

"So, even we... must step back and observe. How can we still pass on the tradition? And be of use to the new generation? We can only entrust this hesitation to art, to dance."

One of the Kimono Girls then spoke, in a calm, almost weary voice, her gaze fixed on the Tin Tower:

"Since then, Johto has tried to make amends for this oversight. But two years' commitment... is not enough."

Another added, more softly, after a silence:

"Johto stands out from Kanto for its cultural wealth. We're proud of that. But we've definitely had to leave the young people to face evil on their own. Sometimes I wonder... if Johto is really any different from Kanto."

Gold/Richter did not reply straight away. He stood motionless. It was clear he was realising something. His gaze drifted for a moment towards the Tin Tower.

Then he spoke, his voice low, almost as if he were talking to himself:

"If we cannot prevent it from happening... we can change the extent to which it happens."

BGM 'Divine Bloodlines Reprise'

Another silence fell, heavier still.

Gold/Richter finally raised his head slightly. There was a tempered, heavy gladness in his voice:

"I have gradually come to understand... My journey has taught me the most precious things: the connection between science and faith, the reinterpretation of tradition, the practising of values... All of this makes us more resilient. I set out to prove that our heritage can still protect us. And I am filled with gratitude towards Johto. Protecting it is my way of expressing that gratitude."

Morty regarded him for a moment, then spoke in a gentle voice:

"Well then, you'll be welcome at my Gym. Not just for the badge, but also for the camaraderie and my knowledge."

Gold/Richter nodded slightly. He then turned his gaze towards Eusine, with a kind of restrained joy.

"Apart from that... if you think of me as a detective, an inspector... my job is to unearth the truth rather than to fight, isn't it? I also want to find out the truth about Red."

Eusine did not know quite how to respond at first. He simply went along with this shared sense of delight, his gaze somewhat unfocused.

Oak, still kneeling, remained silent for a long while. When he finally spoke, his voice was calm, almost matter-of-fact, but with a lingering melancholy visible in the way his fingers remained clenched around the stone:

"Well then... I shall take over from Dr Fuji, so as to complete his work."

Chris/Maria looked at him.

"By the way, Professor... What subjects do Dr Fuji's publications deal with...?"

Oak hesitated for a moment. He finally replied, without quite lifting his head:

"I am well acquainted with his quintessences. But they are rather... abstract. The one most relevant to you: science is a divine extension. We do not really invent anything, but the Lord manifests his wisdom through us. Without realising it, we would degenerate and succumb to arrogance. The Lord does not prevent this transgression. Instead, we bear the consequences."

He paused.

"I know it's still rather abstruse. But I interpret it more as though we inherit the Lord's divinity. We accomplish things at his behest, provided we do not stray."

The wind continued to swirl the last few petals amongst the graves. One of them came to rest gently on the stone, right next to Oak's hand.

End of scene

Scene – As well equipped for a surprise

Ecruteak City, the perfect spot for take-off. Autumn twilight, almost nightfall.

Professor Oak stood there, his luggage already gathered at his feet. He didn't have much, but the extra documents relating to Dr Fuji's estate made the load slightly heavier. He adjusted the strap of his bag one last time, then took a Poké Ball from his inside pocket.

His movement was precise, firm, almost gallant. His arm rose without undue haste, his hand closed with just the right amount of force, and the ball was hurled towards the sky in a sharp, controlled arc.

Skarmory appeared in a metallic flash. It was already kitted out for long-distance flight: reinforced harness, side saddlebags secured, and a small, unlit lantern hanging from its collar. Its steel feathers faintly reflected the fading light.

The wind had picked up. It swirled the last of the fallen leaves amongst the trees, with an almost hesitant slowness, as if they were reluctant to let go. The air had grown cooler, denser. In the distance, the town's lanterns were beginning to light up.

Oak approached unhurriedly and began to secure his belongings to the Pokémon, with methodical, confident movements.

'Right then, I'm counting on you to pass on my regards to Elm,' he said without turning fully round.

BGM "EP01 S02 19:53 20:33"

Chris/Maria, who was standing a little way back beside Gold/Richter, frowned slightly.

"All right. But... are you catching the train at this time of night? It's already late."

Oak finished adjusting the last strap, then straightened up. He took a pair of thin gloves and a flight belt out of his bag, which he put on with an almost casual ease. Over the top, he slipped on a light coat, designed for air travel.

"This unexpected turn of events has kept me here longer than anticipated," he replied in a calm, almost matter-of-fact voice. "I need to be back in Kanto this very evening."

He briefly stroked Skarmory's neck.

"You should know that its Ability is Keen Eye, not Sturdy. It can see clearly, even in the night air. And the Pokémon in the vicinity aren't particularly powerful at this hour."

He hoisted himself onto Skarmory's back with a fluidity surprising for his age. Once in place, he turned his head slightly towards them.

"Take care of yourselves."

There was nothing urgent in his voice. He had noted Gold/Richter's silence, yet he made no attempt to break it. He merely nodded slightly, as if he understood that the young man's thoughts were already elsewhere. Then he gave Skarmory a gentle nudge.

The Pokémon rose unhurriedly, its wings spreading in a sweeping, metallic motion. Within seconds, the dark silhouette drifted off towards the south-west, gradually blending into the sky as it turned indigo.

The wind died down slightly. All that could be heard now was the distant rustling of leaves and the faint hum of the first lanterns.

Gold/Richter stood motionless, his eyes fixed on the spot where Oak had vanished. Chris/Maria stepped closer, silently. She looked at him for a moment before speaking, her voice low, almost cautious:

'Say... what's on your mind?'

He didn't answer straight away. His gaze remained fixed on the empty sky. When he finally spoke, his voice was calm, almost detached, but one could sense he was searching for the right words:

"No. It's just... I've felt something I'd constantly ignored. And avoided. Something important to me. But I've lost it. My true weakness. Perhaps."

He did not turn his head towards her. Chris/Maria did not reply. She stood beside him, arms folded, her gaze fixed on the same spot in the sky.

The wind blew a final dead leaf down between them. It landed silently on the ground.

End of scene

Scene – The Old Man Coyote's Caustic Greeting

In flight between Goldenrod and Ecruteak

The sky was black. The night wind blew in irregular gusts, cold and laden with a dampness that clung to the skin. Skarmory flew steadily, but Oak could already sense that the air had grown heavier, as if something had changed without him being able to put his finger on it.

Suddenly, two red dots rose up from below.

BGM 'She Who Mauls' 02:41–02:48

Oak felt his stomach clench violently. Skarmory tilted a wing more sharply than necessary to regain its balance. The Pokémon had sensed the same thing as him.

BGM “EP01 S02 08:11 – 09:00”

Those two red dots did not rise all at once. They rose slowly, with almost surgical precision, as if they knew exactly how far they could go without being fully illuminated by the lantern. Two red eyes, deep-set and slightly glistening in the darkness. They blinked once, very slowly. The movement that followed was too measured, too deliberate. As if something in the dark were taking its time to smile without having a face. They blinked just once, slowly, without the slightest exaggeration. Just enough to confirm that they were watching.

Oak realised at once. Murkrow did not roam this region by nature. This one was trained. And those red eyes, in the darkness, did not belong to a wild Pokémon.

The Murkrow rose unhurriedly. It barely flapped its wings at all, letting itself be carried by the night-time breeze. It approached from the side, remaining just outside the circle of light. Only its eyes were visible. They stared at Oak and Skarmory without blinking, with a calm, almost clinical focus. No exaggerated mockery. Just patient observation, as if it were taking the time to assess something.

As if Murkrow knew that Oak was intelligent and clear-headed enough to identify it even in total darkness. That was why it deliberately remained out of the light’s reach: it didn’t need to reveal its silhouette. Its mere presence, recognised by Oak’s intellect, was enough.

Oak pulled out his Pokédex with a trembling hand. Level 30 or thereabouts. He knew its moves. Night Shade. Haze. Pursuit. He imagined the Murkrow creeping closer, using Night Shade at point-blank range, or simply getting close enough for Skarmory, in the darkness, to lose its bearings for a moment. He pictured the Pokémon lurching, its altitude plummeting, the black ground rising too quickly. He could almost feel the impact in his bones.

His fingers clenched the reins so tightly that his knuckles turned white. He was struggling to breathe properly. The air seemed to flow less freely into his lungs. He did not see the Murkrow attacking. He only saw everything that *could* happen if the creature chose to. And that possibility had become too vivid, too close.

The Murkrow hung there, motionless in the air, its red eyes fixed on them. It was barely moving. It was watching. And in that gaze, there was something clinical, patient, and strangely amused.

Then, for no apparent reason, it moved away. Slowly. It dived back towards the trees below and vanished amongst the dark branches, as if it had got what it wanted.

The silence that followed was worse than its presence.

Oak did not loosen his grip on the reins. His breathing remained short and irregular. He continued to scan the darkness around them, even after the red eyes had vanished. He knew he hadn’t been attacked. He also knew that it made no difference. The fear had not gone away with the creature’s departure. It clung to him, in his chest, in his hands that refused to relax.

In the night air, then lower down, in the forest, a mocking voice rang out. It did not seem to come from any specific point. It was everywhere and nowhere, slightly distorted by the wind, as if it were passing through the leaves and branches.

‘The Old Man Coyote’s caustic greeting... that was ages ago, my friend.’

The phrase did not fade away completely. It lingered for a moment in the cold air, as if refusing to leave straight away. Then it was swallowed up by the wind, but Oak had the impression that it continued to vibrate faintly somewhere behind him.

Skarmory continued to fly eastwards. Oak said nothing. His hands remained clenched around the reins long after the voice had fallen silent.

End of episode

Close of episode

Totals

≈ 14,000 words · 33 pp. A4 · read aloud ≈ 95 min.

Pass 1/3 — still open

Doublons in Always (Crunch / Arbok contact). Combat presents. Title “Old Coyote’s Derision”. Better not. adapted himself. swirled. pénitenciaire = office, not the building. Note Lance / Gandalf moved here. P1 EN: bullets ≠ Poké Balls; It is too fearsome ≠ He’s too timid; hunting crop ≠ riding crop ≠ whip; Minimize; Electrode (not Electode); Incursion not Invasion/Raid.

Version notes

2026-09-23 — EN-GB apparatus after P1. Traces = EP S span. Incursion = one sequence. EN anchors. Author filled to match 01–04. Grey Sage = Gandalf of the title, not a second character.

Open for what follows

Murkrow · Coyote · Fuji’s writings · the truth about Red · Johto’s modernisation.

BGM credits

Pieces: Castlevania: Nocturne (Netflix), Trevor Morris & Trey Toy. Traces: same source, identified by duration only.

